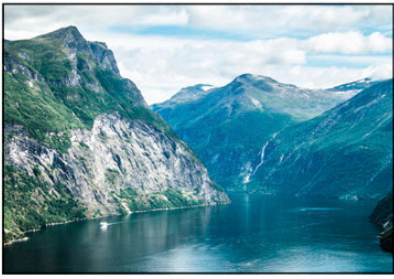


## FACTS ABOUT EUROPE



### Longest coastline

Europe has a longer coastline in proportion to its size than any other continent. Norway's coastline is indented with steep valleys called fjords (above) that were cut into the cliffs by thick glaciers during the last ice age.

### Number of birds

More than 800 species of bird have been spotted in Europe. Of these, about 430 birds are regularly seen there.

### Longest glacier

The longest glacier in the Alps is called the Aletsch and is more than 15 miles (24 km) long.

### High population

Europe only occupies about 7 percent of the world's land area, and has about 10 percent of the world's 7.8 billion people.



### Main mountains

Mont Blanc is 15,770 ft (4,807 m) tall and is western Europe's highest mountain. It forms part of the Alps mountain range, which stretches for 680 miles (1,100 km).

### Volcanic eruptions

The only active volcano on mainland Europe is Vesuvius, in Italy. It began erupting 10,000 years ago and buried the towns of Pompeii and Stabiae in 79 CE.

### Longest rivers

The longest rivers in Europe are: the Volga—2,194 miles (3,531 km); the Danube—1,776 miles (2,858 km); and the Dnieper—1,420 miles (2,285 km) long.

### Largest sea

Europe's Mediterranean Sea is the largest sea in the world.

## Typical birds

Here are a few examples of typical birds from the most important habitats of Europe. These range from dark conifer forests in the north, to more open broad-leaved woodlands further south, and dry scrubland around the shores of the Mediterranean. Rivers, lakes, marshes, and coasts are also major European bird habitats.



### Coasts

Seabirds such as this puffin, along with guillemots, gulls, gannets, and terns, nest in densely packed colonies on cliffs, beaches, and islands around the coasts of Europe in spring and summer.



### Mediterranean scrub

The rich variety of insects in the Mediterranean scrublands in summer attracts insect-eating birds, such as this hoopoe, along with rollers, shrikes, and honey buzzards.



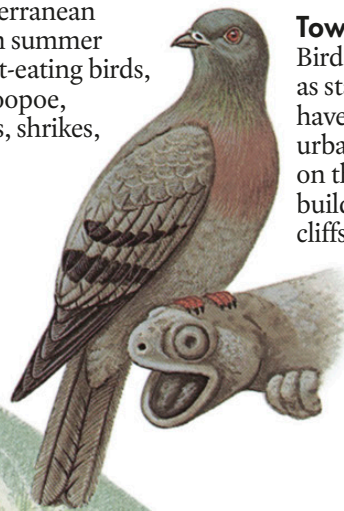
### Moorland

Birds such as this merlin nest on European moors in summer. In winter, they move to marshlands and shores where there is more food available.



### Mountains

Mountains provide refuges from towns and farms for birds such as this chough, as well as golden eagles and vultures.



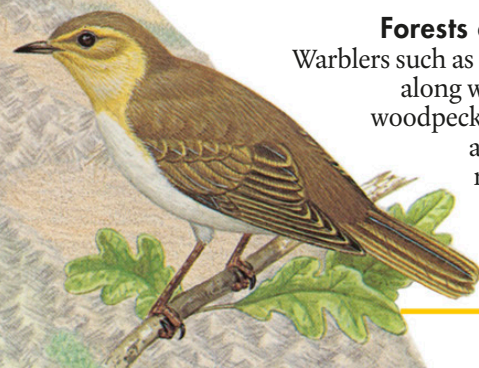
### Towns and cities

Birds such as this pigeon, as well as starlings, sparrows, and kestrels, have made themselves at home in urban habitats. Pigeons nest on the window ledges of tall buildings as if they were cliffs by the coast.



### Estuaries and shores

In winter, waders such as this redshank, along with godwits, dunlin, and curlews, gather in flocks on estuaries and shores to feed on creatures in the mud and sand.



### Forests and woodlands

Warblers such as the wood warbler, along with thrushes, jays, woodpeckers, owls, and tits, are common in the remaining areas of European forests and woodlands.

